

Andrea Salvanti

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EDUCATION	Universitat Pompeu Fabra, <i>Ph.D. Candidate in Economics</i>	2022 Present
	Advisor: Prof. Antonio Penta	
	Universitat Pompeu Fabra, <i>MRes in Economics</i>	2021 2022
	Barcelona School of Economics, <i>M.Sc. in Economics</i>	2020 2021
	University of Bologna, <i>M.Sc. in Economics</i> (summa cum laude) (Thesis Advisor: Maria Bigoni)	2018 2020
	University of Trento, <i>B.Sc. in Economics</i> (summa cum laude)	2015 2018
TEACHING POSITIONS (BSE)	Advanced Microeconomics II (General Equilibrium and Game Theory), first year course of the Ph.D. for Professor Antonio Penta – Spring 2023 and Spring 2024	
	Econometrics, first year course of the Ph.D. for Professor Christian Brownlees – Spring 2022	
	Crash Courses in Math, first year course of the Ph.D. for Professor Alexander Frug – Fall 2022 and Fall 2023	
RESEARCH POSITIONS	Research Assistant for professor Antonio Penta, 2021-2022	
	Research Intern in Bank of Italy, 2021-2023	
	Research Assistant for professor Maria Bigoni, 2019-2020	
JOB MARKET PAPER	Extracting Models from Data: A Cost-Benefit Framework (Draft coming soon) with Patrick Sewell (UPF and BSE) <i>Abstract.</i> We develop a theoretical framework for analyzing how decision makers form theories and extract behavioral rules directly from data. We distinguish a stable data-generating process (DGP) linking a relevant set of variables to outcomes from dataset-specific correlations that can make rules based on irrelevant variables perform well in some datasets but not in others. Rule extraction reflects a cost-benefit trade-off between a rule's value and the cognitive cost of processing it. The framework predicts when agents extract the optimal behavioral rule that generalizes across datasets, how they substitute toward alternatives, when irrelevant variables lower its extraction, and how differences in cognitive costs generate systematic heterogeneity in rule extraction among agents learning from the same data. We test these predictions in our experiment and in the data of Kendall and Oprea (2024), and find strong support for them in both settings. We also show how rule-specific costs can be identified from observed choices and use the framework to determine which observable measures of complexity can be interpreted as entering the cost function.	
WORKING PAPERS	The Importance of Being Even: Restitution and Cooperation (Draft available on the website; R&R at AEJ: Microeconomics) with Maria Bigoni (University of Bologna), Marco Casari (University of Bologna), Andrzej Skrzypacz (Stanford University), and Giancarlo Spagnolo (Roma Tor Vergata) <i>Abstract.</i> We study—empirically and theoretically—how restitution helps restore cooperation after a breach or an exploratory defection. Restitution strategies propose a return to cooperation by cooperating against defection, and condition actions on the balance between cooperation given and received. We reanalyze experimental data from repeated Prisoner's Dilemma games and find empirical support for restitution strategies in general, and for a strategy we name Payback, in particular. Besides explaining how subjects deal with conflicts, accounting for restitution strategies helps reconcile discrepancies between theory and experiments—such as the widespread use of non-equilibrium strategies like Tit-for-Tat and the limited predictive power of risk dominance under imperfect monitoring.	

Choice by Contextual Associations (Draft coming soon)
with Jose Apesteguia (UPF and BSE)

Abstract. It has been amply shown that choice behavior is context-dependent. Evidence from the cognitive sciences suggests that this dependency may be driven by implicit associations. In this paper, we propose and study a choice-based model of contextual associations. We start by formalizing contexts by the set of concepts it contains. We then introduce associations by way of the implicit relationship between alternatives and concepts, which directly impacts the utility evaluation of alternatives. We study the empirical content of the model, establish conditions for identification, characterize its comparative statics, and propose several extensions. We provide an application to probabilistic voting, showing that our model rationalizes how political competition contributes to the polarization of parties' values, as emphasized in the empirical literature.

Strategic Risk in Repeated Games with Imperfect Monitoring (Draft available upon request)

Abstract. In this paper I study the trade-off between efficiency and strategic risk in the context of a repeated Prisoner's Dilemma with imperfect public monitoring. Because unfavorable public signals and resulting punishments can occur on the equilibrium path, keeping the value of cooperation high requires players to adopt more lenient and forgiving strategies, which leaves them more exposed to opportunistic behavior. For a broad class of one-dimensional public signals, I show that under imperfect monitoring, strategy adoption responds to beliefs about the opponent's strategy, whereas under perfect monitoring, beliefs affect only the extensive margin—that is, the decision of whether to cooperate at all. Finally, I use experimental data from Aoyagi and Fréchette (2009) to document suggestive patterns consistent with subjects choosing strategies to maximize the cooperation value rather than controlling for strategic risk.

**ONGOING
WORK**

Exploration and Exploitation with Endogenous Data

The Fundamental Attribution Error in Hiring Decisions

with Eva Spantidaki Kyriazi (University of Vienna)

Self-Projection and Sorting Across Environments

**RESEARCH
GRANTS**

REACT Grant (4,980 €), *Universitat Pompeu Fabra* 2026

**HONORS and
AWARDS**

FPI Scholarship , <i>Spanish Government</i>	2022-2026
Scholarship "G.Mortara" , <i>Bank of Italy</i>	2021
Best Thesis Award and Publication on BSE repository , <i>BSE</i>	2020
Grant for Excellence in studies , <i>University of Bologna</i>	2020
Grant for Excellence in studies , <i>University of Trento</i>	2018
Graduate with Distinction , <i>University of Bologna</i>	2018

**SEMINARS –
CONFERENCES**

Next Presentations

- ESA meeting, Barcelona, September 2026
- Econometric Society meeting, Dublin, August 2026

Presentations

- FUR, Alicante, June 2026
- HEC PhD workshop, Paris, June 2026
- EAYE annual meeting, Bilbao, May 2026
- ASFEE conference, Nancy, June 2025

- Summer School in Experimental and Behavioral Economics (EER), Crete, August 2024
- BSE Summer Forum, Barcelona, June 2023
- EAYE annual meeting, Turin, September 2023

Attendance

- European Symposium of Economic Theory (ESSET), Gerzensee, July 2026
- BSE Summer Forum, Barcelona, June 2022/2023/2024/2025/2026
- ESA meeting, Bologna, September 2022

REFEREING ACTIVITIES Review of Economic Studies; Experimental Economics; European Economic Review; Economia Politica

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION **Programming Languages:** Python, Stata, Wolfram Mathematica, Matlab, R, Latex
Languages Spoken: English (Fluent), Italian (Native), Spanish (Fluent)